



Management

Every manager in a business, particularly in manufacturing, has to ensure that all resources—from materials to equipment and staff—are used efficiently, while keeping the customer continually in mind. Managers make key decisions to lay down procedures and set standards and then work continuously to improve processes to ensure that the company remains profitable.

Which approach?

How people and processes are organized in making and delivering the product to the customer is critical if a company is to survive fierce competition and rapidly shifting consumer demands in a global market. In making decisions about how a business can meet its goals, managers may combine a number of approaches as many are interlinked and achieve similar outcomes.

MANAGER OR LEADER?

Management and leadership are not the same, but are closely linked:

- › Managers **plan, organize, and coordinate**; leaders also **galvanize** and **motivate**.
- › Managers organize workers to **maximize efficiency**; leaders also **nurture skills** and **develop talent**.
- › Managers focus on the **bottom line**; leaders also **look to the horizon**.
- › Managers **tell people** what to do; leaders also **ask questions**.
- › Managers make sure workers are doing everything that **needs to be done**; leaders also inspire workers to **want to do more** than needs to be done.

The following classic distinction has been attributed to two different business leaders and writers, Peter Drucker and Warren Bennis: management is doing things right; leadership is doing the right things.

Agile production

How can we be more responsive to shifts in customer demand?
See pp.296–297.

Time-based management

How can we use time effectively?
See pp.294–295.

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